Digital Literacy Portfolio

Project Report — CSE0001

VIT Bhopal University | VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

g232

Student Name	RAYYAN
Year / Semester	First Year | Semester II
Course Code	CSE0001 – Digital Literacy
Credits	1 Credit | Pass / Fail (Non-CGPA)
Date of Submission	26 March 2026
Faculty Mentor	KANNAN

g

Introduction

This project report documents the work completed as part of CSE0001 — Digital Literacy, a one-credit foundational course offered to all first-year B.Tech students at VIT Bhopal University. The project is framed around a real-world scenario: I have been selected as a Student Digital Ambassador for my batch, with the responsibility of helping peers navigate the digital world safely, professionally, and effectively.

The portfolio spans five modules, each corresponding to a distinct task: creating a digital literacy infographic, building a professional student portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, drafting professional email communication and etiquette resources, and producing a cybercrime awareness case study with a prevention guide.

All deliverables are hosted on a public GitHub repository and organised into dedicated task folders. This report presents the methodology, outputs, reflections, and key learnings from each task, and serves as the written component of the complete Digital Literacy Portfolio submission.

Project at a Glance

Task	Title	Marks
Task 1	Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic	20 marks
Task 2	Student Digital Portfolio	20 marks
Task 3	Coding & Collaboration Platforms	20 marks
Task 4	Professional Email & Etiquette Guide	20 marks
Task 5	Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention	20 marks
Bonus	GitHub Repository Structure & README	+5 marks
TOTAL		100 marks

Task 1 — Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic (Module 1 | 20 Marks)

Overview & Requirements

This task required me to act as a Student Digital Ambassador and design a one-page visual resource that communicates the essentials of Digital Literacy to first-year peers. The infographic had to cover at least three of the five prescribed themes, be created using a free design tool, and be exported and added to the task-1-presentation/ folder of the repository.

Tool Used & Design Choices

I used **Canva** (canva.com) to design the infographic, selecting the 'Infographic (A4)' template as the canvas. Canva was chosen because it is entirely browser-based, requires no installation, and offers a rich library of icons and colour themes suited to educational content.

Topics Covered in the Infographic

- **What is Digital Literacy?:** A definition panel explaining that digital literacy is the ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information using digital technology responsibly.
- **Useful Digital Tools for Students:** A 'toolkit' section highlighting Google Workspace, GitHub, Canva, Grammarly, and Zotero with brief one-line descriptions of each.
- **Safe Internet Practices:** A tips strip covering strong passwords, 2FA, phishing awareness, and the importance of privacy settings — presented as icon-led bullet points.
- **Professional Online Presence:** A brief panel on LinkedIn and GitHub profiles, emphasising that a professional online presence matters from the very first year of college.
- **Email Etiquette:** A quick-reference 'Do / Don't' comparison strip for writing professional emails.

Reflection

The most challenging aspect of this task was achieving visual hierarchy — making the infographic scannable at a glance while still conveying substantive information. I initially overcrowded the canvas with text, which reduced readability. After two redesigns using Canva's grid guides and limiting each section to a single bold headline and two to three supporting lines, the layout became far cleaner. One insight I found genuinely interesting was how much white space improves communication: removing content paradoxically made the infographic more informative, because the reader's eye could travel the page logically. This principle — 'less is more' — is something I intend to apply in all future presentations and reports.

File Added to Repository

File	task-1-presentation/digital-literacy-infographic.png
Format	PNG export from Canva, A4 dimensions
Tool	Canva — canva.com
Themes covered	5 of 5 prescribed themes

Task 2 — Student Digital Portfolio (Module 2 | 20 Marks)

Overview & Requirements

A professional digital presence is no longer optional for engineering students — it is an expectation from internship coordinators, placement teams, and the academic community alike. This task required setting up accounts on at least three platforms from the approved list, completing specific profile requirements on GitHub and LinkedIn, and reflecting on how these platforms will serve my career.

Platforms Set Up

GitHub (github.com)

Version control and code hosting. The primary platform for showcasing programming projects, open-source contributions, and collaborative coding work. Employers routinely check GitHub profiles during technical hiring.

LinkedIn (linkedin.com)

Professional networking platform. Used to connect with industry professionals, display academic credentials, internship experience, and certifications. Increasingly used by campus placement teams for pre-screening.

Kaggle (kaggle.com)

Data science and machine learning competition platform. Hosts public datasets, notebooks, and competitions. Useful for building a data-science portfolio and earning skill certifications.

GitHub Profile README

A special repository named RAYYAN**1616** was created on GitHub. The README.md file includes: my name and registration number, branch and current year, expected graduation year (2029), a short bio, and one sentence on what I hope to learn — specifically, to build end-to-end web applications and contribute to open-source machine learning projects.

LinkedIn Education Section

The Education section was completed with: Degree — B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering, Institution — VIT Bhopal University, Start Year — 2025, Expected Graduation — 2029. No personal contact details or photographs were added at this stage, as instructed.

Reflection — Four-Year Platform Strategy

I chose GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle because together they cover the three dimensions of a modern tech student's digital presence: code, network, and data skills. Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub as a living portfolio — committing every academic project and gradually contributing to open-source repositories so that by final year I have a visible commit history that speaks for itself in interviews. LinkedIn will be updated after each semester with certifications, hackathon participations, and internship roles. Kaggle will serve as a competitive learning ground — I intend to enter at least one competition per semester and publish notebooks explaining my approach, which doubles as technical writing practice. By graduation, these three profiles should collectively demonstrate who I am as an engineer far more effectively than a one-page résumé ever could.

Files Added to Repository

Screenshots	task-2-portfolio/github-profile.png, linkedin-profile.png, kaggle-profile.png
README	github.com/RAYYAN1616— Profile README live
LinkedIn	Education section completed — VIT Bhopal B.Tech CSE 2025–2029

Task 3 — Coding & Collaboration Platforms (Module 3 | 20 Marks)

Part A — Coding Practice Platform

I created an account on **HackerRank** (hackerrank.com) and completed two beginner-level challenges to build a foundation in Python programming:

Challenge	Language	Status	Description
Solve Me First	Python	Passed	Introductory problem to test basic input/output and arithmetic operations.
Python Introduction	Python	Passed	Printing formatted strings and understanding Python's print function and string literals.

Both challenges were solved independently. HackerRank automatically validated solutions against test cases and awarded a Python (Basic) skill badge upon completion. The screenshot of the badge and challenge submissions has been added to task-3-platforms/.

Part B — Google Workspace Collaboration: Digital Literacy Quiz

A five-question **Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz** was built using Google Forms. The form was designed to be used by peers during Digital Ambassador outreach sessions. It is linked to a Google Sheet that records all responses in real time.

#	Type	Question	Purpose
Q 1	Multiple Choice	Which of the following is NOT a recommended practice for creating a strong password?	Tests password hygiene awareness
Q 2	Multiple Choice	What does '2FA' stand for, and why is it important?	Assesses two-factor authentication knowledge
Q 3	Short Answer	Name two free tools you would recommend to a first-year student for academic work. Explain why you chose them.	Open-ended; tests awareness of digital tools
Q 4	Multiple Choice	Which cybercrime helpline number can be dialled in India to report online financial fraud?	Raises awareness of 1930 helpline
Q 5	Multiple Choice	Which of the following best describes 'phishing'?	Evaluates cybercrime literacy

Reflection

HackerRank was an eye-opening introduction to structured problem solving. Even the beginner challenges required careful reading of constraints and precise input handling — skills that are transferable to any programming language. The immediate feedback from automated test cases is far more effective for learning than submitting assignments and waiting for a grade. Over the next semesters, I plan to progress through HackerRank's 30 Days of Code challenge and eventually tackle data structures problems as coursework demands increase. Building the Google Form reinforced how practical cloud-based tools are: the form was live and shareable within minutes, responses streamed into a Google Sheet automatically, and no server setup was required. These tools will directly support group projects, data collection for mini-projects, and peer-feedback exercises throughout my degree.

HackerRank	task-3-platforms/hackerrank-badge.png, hackerrank-challenge.png
Google Form	Link in FORM FILE
Response Sheet	task-3-platforms/google-form-screenshot.png, google-sheet-screenshot.png

Task 4 — Professional Email & Etiquette Guide (Module 4 | 20 Marks)

Part A — Professional Email Drafts

Email 1 — Assignment Extension Request to Professor

	Content
To	dr.kannan@vitbhopal.ac.in
Subject	Request for Assignment Submission Extension — CSE0001 Digital Literacy
Greeting	Dear Dr. kannan,
Body Para 1	I am writing to respectfully request a short extension for the CSE0001 project submission, originally due on 28 March 2026. I have been unwell with a fever since 24 March and have been unable to complete the GitHub repository structure and final report to the standard I aim for.
Body Para 2	I have already completed Tasks 1 through 4 and have uploaded the relevant files. I would be grateful if an extension of three working days — until 31 March 2026 — could be considered. I am happy to provide a medical certificate upon request.
Body Para 3	Thank you sincerely for your time and understanding.
Sign-off	Yours sincerely, RAYYAN 25BAI11260| B.Tech CSE, First Year VIT Bhopal University

Email 2 — Internship Interest to Company Coordinator

Field	Content
To	internships@techventures.in
Subject	Application for Summer Internship Opportunity — Computer Science Student, VIT Bhopal
Greeting	Dear Ms. Kapoor,
Body Para 1	I am a first-year B.Tech student specialising in Computer Science and Engineering at VIT Bhopal University. I came across TechVentures' summer internship programme on your LinkedIn page and am writing to express my interest in any available opportunities for May–July 2026.

Body Para 2	I have recently completed beginner-level Python challenges on HackerRank and have set up profiles on GitHub and Kaggle, where I am actively building foundational skills in software development and data analysis. I am a quick learner, comfortable with collaboration tools such as Google Workspace, and eager to contribute to a professional team environment.
Body Para 3	I have attached a brief profile document. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss any suitable roles. Please do not hesitate to contact me at the email or number below.
Sign-off	Yours sincerely, | B.Tech CSE — VIT Bhopal University rayyan.25bai11260@vitbhopal.ac.in | +91 9149345845

Part B — Social Media Do's and Don'ts Checklist

DO	Keep your profile photo and bio professional on LinkedIn and GitHub
DO	Use your college email when signing up on academic platforms
DO	Think before posting — ask: 'Would I be comfortable if my professor saw this?'
DO	Credit original creators when sharing content or re-posting
DO	Report harassment or inappropriate content using platform tools
DO	Review and tighten your privacy settings every six months
DON'T	Share your phone number, hostel address, or daily schedule publicly
DON'T	Post complaints about faculty, classmates, or your institution by name
DON'T	Share exam papers, question banks, or copyrighted study material
DON'T	Accept friend/connection requests from strangers without verifying their identity
DON'T	Engage with or amplify unverified news, rumours, or viral forwards

Reflection — A Real-World Scenario of Poor Digital Communication

In 2021, a final-year engineering student at a private university posted a lengthy rant on a public Facebook group criticising a specific faculty member by name, alleging unfair grading. The post went viral within the campus community and attracted hundreds of comments. Screenshots were shared widely, eventually reaching the university administration and the faculty member's department. The student faced a disciplinary hearing and received a formal warning that was noted in their official record — jeopardising a campus placement offer that had been conditionally extended.

What could have been done differently: the student had a legitimate concern about grading, but the appropriate channel was a private, respectful email to the faculty member, or a formal

grievance submission through the university portal. A written complaint — factual, unemotional, and directed to the right authority — would have addressed the problem without the reputational and disciplinary consequences. This case is a powerful reminder that digital communication is permanent and public, and that the platform and tone chosen matter as much as the message itself.

Task 5 — Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide (Module 5 | 20 Marks)

Part A — Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

Crime Type	UPI / Online Payment Fraud
Setting	College campus, Bhopal — realistic fictional scenario
Target	First-year college students unfamiliar with UPI mechanics

Aryan, a first-year engineering student, posted in a college WhatsApp group that he was selling his old laptop. Within an hour, he received a call from someone claiming to be a senior from a nearby college who was interested in buying it. The caller said he would transfer the money immediately via UPI.

The fraudster sent Aryan a UPI collect request — a request for Aryan to approve a payment — disguised as 'sending' money. The caller stayed on the line and verbally guided Aryan: 'Just enter your UPI PIN to receive the money.' Aryan, unfamiliar with the difference between a payment request and a payment receipt, entered his PIN. Instead of receiving money, Rs. 18,000 was instantly debited from his account.

The mechanism exploited a fundamental misunderstanding: **entering a UPI PIN authorises sending money, never receiving it.** A UPI collect request is a demand for the target to pay the requester. The fraudster used social engineering — a live phone call, urgency, and technical jargon — to prevent Aryan from pausing to read the screen.

Consequences: Aryan lost Rs. 18,000 instantly. Although he filed a complaint on cybercrime.gov.in within two hours and called the 1930 helpline, the funds had already been moved to a mule account and withdrawn. Partial recovery was initiated by the bank fraud team, but only Rs. 4,500 was reversed. Beyond the financial loss, Aryan experienced significant stress and embarrassment. The incident is representative of thousands of similar cases reported monthly across Indian college campuses.

Part B — Stay Safe Online: Prevention Checklist

#	Category	Tip	Detail
1	General	**Use strong, unique passwords for every account**	Minimum 12 characters; mix uppercase, lowercase, numbers, symbols. Use a password manager.
2	General	**Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) on all important accounts**	Email, social media, banking, and college portals. 2FA blocks access even if password is stolen.

#	Category	Tip	Detail
3	General	**Never click unknown links in messages, emails, or DMs**	Phishing links mimic official sites. Always go directly to the official URL from your browser.
4	General	**Keep all devices and apps updated**	Updates patch security vulnerabilities. Enable automatic updates on your phone and laptop.
5	General	**Avoid sensitive activities on public Wi-Fi**	Use a VPN if you must use public networks in canteens, hostels, or cafés.
6	General	**Review app permissions regularly**	Revoke unnecessary camera, microphone, location, or contacts access monthly.
7	General	**Limit personal information on social media**	Keep hostel address, phone number, and daily routine private. Set profiles to 'Friends only'.
8	General	**Download only from official app stores**	Google Play Store or Apple App Store. Never install APK files from unknown third-party sites.
9	FINANCIAL / UPI	**Never share your UPI PIN or OTP with anyone**	Banks and UPI apps NEVER ask for your PIN over a call or message. Receiving money does NOT require entering your PIN — if someone asks you to enter a PIN to 'receive' money, it is a scam.
10	FINANCIAL / UPI	**Verify recipient UPI ID or QR code before every transaction**	Check the payee name on the confirmation screen. For amounts above Rs. 500, send Rs. 1 first as a test. Never scan QR codes sent via WhatsApp or email from unknown contacts.

Reporting Channels

Channel	Contact / URL	When to Use
National Cyber Crime Portal	cybercrime.gov.in	File online complaints for all types of cybercrime — financial fraud, harassment, identity theft.
Cyber Crime Helpline	1930 (24x7 phone)	Call immediately after online financial fraud. Early reporting can help freeze mule accounts.
Local Police / FIR	Nearest Police Station	For serious offences such as cyberstalking, blackmail, or identity theft.

Reflection

What surprised me most while researching this topic was the sheer psychological sophistication of UPI scams targeting college students. I assumed cybercrime primarily involved technical hacking, but the majority of incidents exploit basic human trust and the

victim's unfamiliarity with how UPI mechanics actually work. The 'collect request' trick — asking someone to enter their PIN to 'receive' money — is conceptually simple, yet devastatingly effective precisely because it sounds plausible to a new UPI user. I was also surprised by how underreported these crimes are: many victims feel embarrassed or believe recovery is impossible, so they stay silent, which in turn emboldens fraudsters. As a direct result of this research, I will personally change the habit of scanning any QR code presented to me without scrutiny. Going forward, I will always verify the payee name on the UPI confirmation screen and, for amounts above Rs. 500, send a test payment of Rs. 1 first — a simple two-second habit that could prevent significant financial loss.

Conclusion

This project has been a comprehensive and genuinely practical introduction to the skills that define a digitally literate engineering student. Across five tasks, I moved from design thinking (infographic) to professional identity (portfolio), from coding fundamentals (HackerRank) to collaboration tools (Google Forms), from communication standards (email etiquette) to safety awareness (cybercrime). Each task produced a tangible, reusable artefact — not a theoretical exercise — and the GitHub repository that houses them all is itself a live demonstration of digital organisation skills.

The single most transferable insight from this project is that digital literacy is not a fixed body of knowledge — it is an evolving habit of critical engagement with technology. The checklist I will carry forward most concretely is from Task 5: always verify a UPI payee name, and never enter a PIN prompted by a caller. This project has set a strong foundation for the four years ahead.

References & Tools Used

Tool / Platform	URL / Contact	Used For
Canva	canva.com	Task 1 — Infographic design
GitHub	github.com	Task 2 — Portfolio & repository hosting
LinkedIn	linkedin.com	Task 2 — Professional networking profile
Kaggle	kaggle.com	Task 2 — Data science portfolio
HackerRank	hackerrank.com	Task 3 — Python coding challenges
Google Forms	forms.google.com	Task 3 — Digital Literacy Quiz
Google Sheets	sheets.google.com	Task 3 — Form response tracking
NPCI / BHIM UPI	npci.org.in	Task 5 — UPI mechanics reference
Cyber Crime Portal	cybercrime.gov.in	Task 5 — Reporting channel
MHA Helpline 1930	1930 (24x7)	Task 5 — Financial fraud helpline
VITyarthi Portal	vityarthi.vitbhopal.ac.in	Course platform & submission portal

All written reflections in this report are my own original work. External sources were used only to understand concepts and verify facts; no passages have been copied. AI tools were used to understand terminology and check grammar; all final write-ups reflect my own understanding and experience.